June 18, 2025

To: Engr. Archelle Bea-Baculi, PME
National President

Thru: Engr. James Bernard C. Itao, PME
Chairman, ICT Office

Engr. Loreto G. Catalan, PME
Chairman, Membership

Subject: *Recommendation and Sign-Off: Proposed Revision to Membership Gateway Options*

Dear Engr. Baculi,

As part of our continuing efforts to enhance the digital infrastructure of the Philippine Society of Mechanical Engineers, Inc. (PSME), I respectfully submit for your review and approval a proposed revision to the existing PSME Membership Gateway system.

While the current online portal has been effective in processing new membership applications, feedback and observations have revealed growing concerns regarding the system's responsiveness—particularly for members with pre-existing or manually-verified statuses, such as Life Members and those who have completed payments via their local chapters. At present, these members must manually claim their membership within the system, triggering a time-consuming manual verification process by the membership administrators.

This process introduces the following operational challenges:

- Increased administrative burden due to manual claim validation
- Delayed activation of member access
- Reduced member satisfaction and experience

As discussed during our coordination meeting dated **June 10, 2025**, we recommend the following system revisions to address the above concerns:

Summary of Proposed Revisions:

- **New *(Button Label: "New")***
  - **Description**: For individuals applying for PSME membership for the first time.
  - **Purpose**: Intended for applicants who have never been registered with the Society in any capacity.
  - **Workflow**:
    - The user completes the full membership application form.
    - The system performs basic data validation.
    - Payment at **new membership rates** is required.
    - Upon successful payment, the membership is **automatically activated**.
  - **Potential Risks**:
    - Returning members may mistakenly or intentionally register as new, pay a **higher rate**, and later request refunds.
  - **Notes**: Fully automated; no manual intervention by administrators.
- **Renewal *(Button Label: "Renew")***
  - **Description**: For existing or returning members whose memberships are due for renewal, including those who paid through their respective chapters.
  - **Purpose**: To streamline the process for renewing membership via the gateway at **renewal rates**.
  - **Workflow**:
    - The user completes the standard membership form.
    - The system performs basic data validation.
    - Payment at **renewal rate** is required.
    - Upon successful payment, membership is **automatically reactivated**.
  - **Potential Risks**:
    - **No validation** to confirm if the user is a returning member.
    - New applicants may unintentionally select this option and pay a **lower rate**, creating inconsistencies and potential loss of revenue.
  - **Notes**: Renewal is not applicable for Life Members. No manual review required; however, better validation could prevent misuse.
- **Claim Membership *(Button Label: "Claim")***
  - **Description**: For users who are already recognized members through external processes, such as **Life Members** or **new board passers** with complimentary memberships.
  - **Purpose**: To allow these users to claim their membership status and activate their access to the online system.
  - **Workflow**:
    - The user completes the membership application form.
    - The system attempts to validate the user's identity and category eligibility.
    - **No payment required**.
    - Claims are routed for **manual review and approval by membership administrators**.

        - Expected activation time is **1–3 business days** (improved from 3–5).
    - **Potential Risks**:
        - Manual verification is time-consuming and **causes delays** in processing.
        - The rising volume of claims is **increasing the workload** of the membership administration team.
    - **Option Labels to Membership Value:**
        - Life Member -> Life Membership
        - Feb 2025 New Board Passer (RMEE) -> Regular Membership
        - Feb 2025 New Board Passer (CPM) -> Associate Membership
    - **Notes**:
        - This is currently the only workflow with required manual intervention.
        - NPB options are ideally editable for admins and have a switch to toggle on/off visibility. (NPBs are promotional and may not be applicable all the time)
- **Generally Applicable Notes:**
    - Validate, do not proceed, and return an error message if existing PRC License Type and Number Combination already matches (i.e. PME - 1234) to avoid duplicates. Advise user to contact support at membership@psmeinc.org.ph

Membership Type	Current Workflow	Proposed Workflow
New	- The user fills out an application form. - Pays at a new **membership rate**. - Membership is **automatically activated**.	- The user fills out an application form. - Pays at a new **membership rate**. - Membership is **automatically activated**.
Renewal	*(No separate option)* - Members renewing through chapters or outside the system use the **Claim** process. - Requires **manual approval**. - Often delayed due to volume.	- Introduced as a **separate workflow**. - The user fills out an application form. - Pays at **renewal rate**. - Membership is **automatically activated**.
Claim (Life Members / New Board Passers)	- The user fills out an application form. - **No payment** or already paid externally. - Requires **manual verification** by admin. - Activation in **3–5 business days**. - Includes all: Life Members & New Board Passers.	- The user fills out an application form. - **No payment** (Life Members/New Board Passers). - Activation in **1–3 business days**. - Separate from formal Renewal workflow.

Side-by-Side Comparison of Current vs Proposed Workflow

Limited-Time Availability of "Claim Membership" Feature
The system must support hiding the "Claim Membership" feature by default, with the ability to re-enable it temporarily for specific use cases (e.g., new board passers or membership drives). A full toggle feature is planned for future development.

Temporary Workaround:
Until the toggle is available, Smartech will manually reinstate the feature upon request, with a *3–5 working day lead time*. Deactivation must also be requested formally. This ensures flexibility while aligning with the planned phase-out.

Additional Note: Event Bulk Registration
Smartech proposed using their existing template (used with IIEE) for bulk event registration. While similar to our process, we recommend handling uploads internally via Sir Allan's team for better control and consistency. This can be reconsidered if needed.

These proposed changes aim to streamline claim verification, reduce manual administrative steps, and improve system responsiveness—ultimately supporting a more seamless experience for all PSME members.

Upon your approval, this document will serve as the official reference for development and deployment of the revised membership gateway workflows.

Should you have any questions or require further clarification, I am available for consultation and technical support.

Thank you for your attention and continued leadership.

Respectfully yours,

John Julius Baldia
IT Consultant

Endorsed for Approval:

Engr. James Bernard C. Itao, PME
Chairman, ICT Office

Engr. Loreto G. Catalan. PME
Chairman, Membership